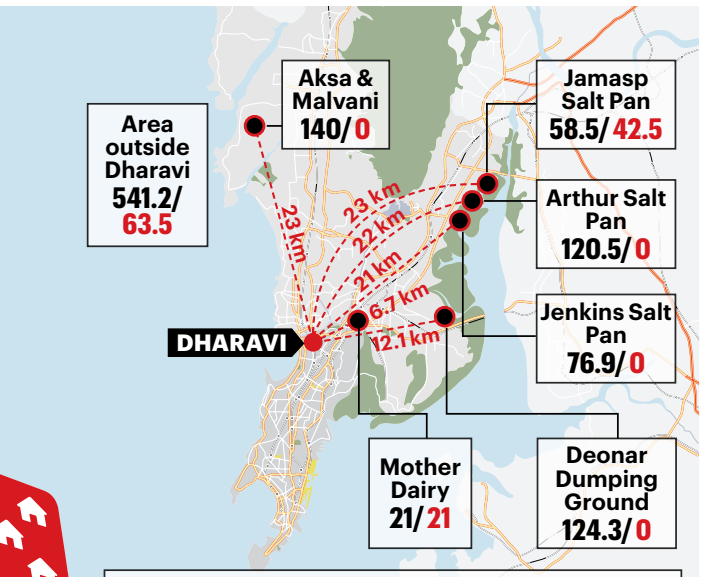


For those being rehabilitated outside Dharavi, 541.2 ACRES have been allocated to build affordable/rental housing. Here, construction will take place for open market sale as well

**Within and outside Dharavi; includes FSI, i.e. Floor Space Index or the maximum allowable built-up area on a plot, expressed as a multiple of the plot's size, and TDR, i.e. Transferable Development Rights granted for land surrendered for public use, which can be sold or used to increase built-up area on another plot beyond its base FSI*

#Numbers can vary, as development will take place in a staggered manner, over 25 years. Such projects can typically earn 15-20% margins, but experts say this is a particularly risky project; therefore calculations for profit are done assuming the lower limit (15%)

Land Development Authority (RLDA) for 30 years. The BMC has also launched a Rs 2,368 crore project to clear 18.5 million tonnes of legacy waste from the Deonar dumping ground using biomining technology to reclaim the land. The civic body will retain just 136 of the total 260 acres here, with the rest going to the Dharavi rehab project.

However, sources stress that the land ownership will be vested with the DRP (i.e. the state government); no land parcel allotted for the Dharavi redevelopment project will be signed over to Adani directly. Meanwhile, in another move that has raised eyebrows, the Maharashtra government has also mandated that Mumbai developers who wish to use TDR must purchase at least 40 per cent of it from the Dharavi project.

Construction has already begun on the 45-acre railway plot (the very one that landed the project in the Adani Group's lap). In Dharavi, too, a multi-stage survey with drones, physical lane recces, alpha-numeric numbering of houses, a high-resolution lane LIDAR (a laser-based remote sensing method to measure distances and create 3D models) and door-to-door audit of documents is under way, with the data uploaded onto an encrypted digital platform. "This is a legacy project," says



"We all want development, but should it be Dharavi's or Adani's? If Dharavikars are not getting homes here, what and who is this redevelopment for?"

—AADITYA THACKERAY, *Shiv Sena (UBT)*

an NMDPL spokesperson. "We are going beyond contractual obligations and focusing on housing, infrastructure and social impact. Against the mandated eight per cent open space, the new Dharavi will offer double: 16 per cent. This will become a place people choose to live in." There will also be some 'decongestion'. After the plan is implemented, Dharavi's population is expected to fall to 485,713, less than half of what it is currently (the other half will be moved out to the new townships).

Robust connectivity could be Dharavi's ace in the hole. Line 11 of the Mumbai Metro will be extended to the heart of Dharavi to create a multi-modal transit hub, the city's first such facility. Rail access to Mahim, Bandra, GTB Nagar, Kings Circle and Matunga road stations, proximity to the arterial western and eastern express highways, metro links and the high-speed rail a.k.a. bullet train being developed for the next-door BKC business district could make it a real estate hotspot. NMDPL sources say the new Dharavi is being envisioned as a future-ready city. International architects and planners are being roped in. Signature features will include the 'Mithi Drive' along the Mithi River (akin to Mumbai's Marine Drive), an expansive central park and a 'green spine' across the length of Dharavi that will also help flood mitigation.

THE CHALLENGES

Visions of a future-ready city notwithstanding, many Dharavikars face another piquant situation—the displaced population may find themselves unwanted in areas earmarked for their rehabilitation. Residents in Kurla and Malvani are already opposing the construction of rental housing schemes in their areas, with the reasons ranging from pressure on already overloaded infrastructure to a change in demography once the resettlement is complete (a significant number of those who will be shifted may be Muslims). Protesting locals have halted surveys in Aksa and Malvani.

Meanwhile, environmentalists say "creating a cement jungle" in the salt pan lands—Jamasp, Jenkins and Arthur—would have massive implications for Mumbai's ecology. D. Stalin of the NGO Vanashakti says the salt pans act as giant sponges during the rains, soaking up excess water. If these areas are built up, it would increase the likelihood of floods